Task Prioritization

Step 1: Think of things you need to do for the week.

1. Make a list of things you *need* to do
2. Make a list of things you *want* to do
3. Tip: consult your course outlines and calendar for relevant assignments and tasks
4. Think about why you need or want to do each of these things

Step 2: Arrange the things you need and want to do into four categories.

School	Work
Home	Social

Compare the differences between the sorting of categories for things that you want to do and the things you need to do.

Step 3: Use a priorities matrix to help structure your to-do list.

Projects with deadlines	Quadrant 1 Urgent & important	Quadrant 2 Not urgent but important	Long term planning
Interruptions	Quadrant 3 Urgent but not important	Quadrant 4 Not urgent & not important	Busywork, distraction

To determine where a task aligns with the matrix, ask yourself:

- When is the deadline?
- What is non-negotiable?
- What are your long-term goals and priorities?

Aim to spend your time in Quadrant 2, planning and working ahead of deadline.

Create daily to-do lists with tasks form Quadrants 1 & 2

Avoid items in Quadrant 4 to be as productive as possible.

Review your list at the start of each day to check that you are on track.

Sources: McGill Teaching and Learning Services; James Madison University

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https://sites.google.com/view/gears-game/